

The Winners!

In this comparison of branded PCs, we saw a spectrum of features and specifications. Some were more suited to high-performance gaming while others were tailored towards productivity and some, though low on specifications and sheer processing horsepower, were suited to general-purpose, non-demanding applications.

In this shootout, the computer that came out tops in terms of sheer performance was the **Visualan Lavish**, which bagged our Best Performance Award. With best-of-class components such as the 2.53 GHz Pentium 4 processor, 256 MB of DDR RAM and a speedy 40 GB 7,200-rpm Seagate Barracuda hard disk, this system had a very strong core to tackle most performance applications. The graphics subsystem was also very strong with the ATi Radeon 7500 graphics accelerator paired with the 17-inch LG E700S Flatron monitor. The roomy cabinet left plenty of room for expansion. This was also the only system to bundle a

wireless mouse and a very able 32x CD-RW drive. In terms of peripherals, it had a 56K PCI modem and an integrated Intel Pro 100 LAN card. It was pre-loaded with Windows XP Home Edition and also carried a CD of the OS. Also bundled were numerous games such as *Motocross Mania*, *4x4 Evolution*, *Serious Sam*, *Heavy Metal*

F.A.K.K.2 and *Rune*. The package also included Nero 9.0, PowerDVD 4.0 along with a blank CD-RW disk—all for a price of Rs 74,000. Armed with very powerful core components and a good graphics subsystem, this computer marched triumphantly into the gaming and multimedia authoring arena.

Our Best Value Award went to the **Visualan Celebrity**. This computer was based on an older 810E-based chipset and ran a 1.2 GHz Celeron based on the Tualatin core along with a 40 GB, 5,400-rpm Seagate hard disk and 128 MB of SDRAM. It also featured integrated sound and graphics and included a simple stereo speaker system, a 52x CD-ROM drive and a 15-inch LG Studioworks monitor. The bundled software was quite comprehensive and included applications such as CD Ghost, Genesys, Language Genius, Media Ring Talk, PC-Cillin Antivirus, PC DJ, Recovery Genius and Super Voice. Given its meagre horsepower, it cannot handle CPU and graphics-hungry applications well, but at Rs 25,750, is among the lowest-priced systems you could opt for when it comes to general-purpose applications such as office suites and Internet browsing.

Our extensive comparison tests proved that there is more to a branded PC than just specifications. These computers do not stop at offering just speed, but extend the utilitarian value to after-sales support and service. Be it intensive gaming, audio-video editing, surfing or plain keeping tabs of the grocery you will find one that serves your need! 

YATISH SUVARNA, MITUL MEHTA and MARCO D'SOUZA



The Visualan Lavish impressed us with its awesome processing and graphics firepower



For general-purpose applications, the Visualan Celebrity leads the pack in performance and price